

Daily Current Affairs – Class Notes

Compiled from Class Session • Date: 17 September 2026

1. India–Pakistan Naval Ship Collision (Arabian Sea)

- A Pakistani naval ship, named **Hunain** (reported in some newspapers as **Alamgir**), collided with an Indian Navy warship in the **Arabian Sea** while the Indian ship was on routine patrol.
- India's **Ministry of External Affairs** lodged a formal protest, calling the act 'unsafe and unprofessional'; India says it had earlier warned Pakistan about the ship's approach. A similar incident had occurred in **2011** as well.
- UNCLOS (UN Convention on the Law of the Sea), 1982**: water beyond **200 nautical miles** from the coast is classified as International Water, open to all nations.
- A **1991** rule mandates a minimum distance of **3 nautical miles** between naval ships of different nations in international waters.
- India's key naval assets (context): **INS Vikrant** – aircraft carrier; **INS Arihant** – nuclear submarine; **INS Aridaman** – India's newest nuclear-capable submarine.
- Background geography: China is developing Pakistan's **Gwadar Port**; **Balochistan** seeks independence (marked its own 'Independence Day' on 11 August); **Karachi** lies on the Arabian Sea coast, where the **Indus River** forms its delta; Pakistan is also called the '**Canal Country**'.

2. Static GK Snippets

- Jhanjhar** folk dance – Himachal Pradesh; **Dhamal** folk dance – Haryana.
- Book '*The Day I Stopped Drinking Milk*' – author **Sudha Murty**.
- Book '*Shakti: The Divine Feminine*' – author **Anuja Chandramouli**.
- Title '**Dakshinapatha Lord**' (Lord of the South) was adopted by the Chalukya king **Pulakeshin**.
- Article 18** of the Constitution provides for '**Abolition of Titles**'.

3. India–New Zealand Free Trade Agreement (FTA)

- New Zealand's Parliament has given its approval to the **India–New Zealand FTA** (India had already approved it earlier); this follows PM **Christopher Luxon's** visit to India for the **Raisina Dialogue** in Delhi.
- An FTA removes/reduces **tariffs** and import duties between two trading nations.
- India has now signed FTAs with a total of **38 countries**; earlier FTAs include one with **Australia** and one with the **European Union** (27 countries, called the 'Mother of all Deals').
- New Zealand facts: Capital – **Wellington**; divided into **North Island** and **South Island**, separated by the **Cook Strait**; highest peak – **Mount Cook**; Mount **Taranaki** was granted legal 'personhood' status; indigenous tribe – **Maori (Haka Maori)**; grasslands are called '**Canterbury**'; largest city – **Auckland**; lies on the Pacific Ocean and on the **Ring of Fire**.

4. Karnataka: 'Er.' Prefix for Engineers

- On **Engineers' Day (15 September)**, the Karnataka government announced that registered engineers may now prefix '**Er.**' before their names.
- This applies **only in Karnataka**, not pan-India, because **Article 18** (Abolition of Titles) restricts use of titles – 'Er.' is treated as an **educational qualification** marker (like 'Dr.' for doctors/PhD holders), not a title.
- Engineers' Day (15 September) marks the birth anniversary of engineer **Sir M. Visvesvaraya**, former Diwan of Mysore.
- M. Visvesvaraya was awarded the **Bharat Ratna in 1955**; the Bharat Ratna award itself was instituted in **1954** and is India's **highest civilian award**.

5. Economy & Corporate

- Deepak Gupta** – CMD (Chairman & Managing Director) of **GAIL** (Gas Authority of India Limited).
- New Economic Policy (Liberalisation)** was introduced in India in **1991**.
- USSR** disintegrated in **1991**, forming **15 countries**; the largest successor state is **Russia**.
- Primary sector** of the economy includes **agriculture and farming**.

6. World Happiness Report

- Released by the **UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network**.
- As discussed in class, India's happiest city (per the data cited) was **Kanpur**.

7. Kishau Multipurpose Project

- A **Rs. 15,000 crore** agreement has been signed among **five states** (Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Rajasthan, Haryana, Uttar Pradesh) and **Delhi** for the **Kishau Multipurpose Project**.
- 'Multipurpose' – the project will generate **electricity**, supply water for **irrigation**, and provide water storage via canals.
- Built on the **Tons River**, located on the **Himachal Pradesh–Uttarakhand border**; about **90%** of the funding comes from the **Central Government**.
- Power generation: **4 units of 165 MW** each.
- River hierarchy: **Yamuna** is the largest tributary of the **Ganga**; **Tons** is the largest tributary of the **Yamuna** (Chambal is another major Yamuna tributary).
- Related landmarks on the Yamuna system: **Lakhwar Dam** (Uttarakhand) and **Renuka Lake**.

8. Science & Technology

- FireSat** – a satellite developed by **Google** to detect and help control forest fires.
- Adrenal gland** was discussed as a key endocrine gland of the human body.
- The **International Space Station (ISS)** orbits in **Low Earth Orbit**, above roughly **400 km** altitude.

9. Sports Terminology & Events

- '**Knee Hold**' is a term used in **Kabaddi**; Kabaddi is the **national sport of Bangladesh**.
- Zimbabwean wicketkeeper **Brendan Taylor** has broken **Sachin Tendulkar's** record for the **longest international cricket career**.

- Taylor: ODI debut in **2004** (vs Sri Lanka); retired in **2021**; made a comeback in **2025** and is still playing in 2026; total international career – **22 years 148 days** (currently playing in a Zimbabwe vs Australia series).
- Sachin Tendulkar's international career was **22 years 91 days**; he announced retirement in **2013**, after India's **2011 World Cup** win.
- 3rd on this career-longevity list: **Sri Lanka's** veteran batsman.
- The **2027 Cricket World Cup** will be co-hosted by **Zimbabwe, South Africa and Namibia**; the recent **U-19 World Cup** was held in **Harare** (capital of Zimbabwe).
- **West Bengal** won the **Junior Boys' National Football Championship (B.C. Roy Trophy)**, beating **Manipur** (runner-up) 3-1; tournament held in **Bengaluru**. (B.C. Roy Trophy is linked to National Doctor's Day – 1 July.)

10. 69th Commonwealth Parliamentary Conference

- India's parliamentary delegation attended the **69th Commonwealth Parliamentary Conference** in **Cape Town, South Africa** (13–19 September).
- Delegation included **Harivansh Ji** (Deputy Chairman, Rajya Sabha) and **P.C. Modi** (Secretary General, Rajya Sabha).
- Commonwealth history: proposal first floated via the **Balfour Declaration, 1926**; the Commonwealth of Nations was formally established in **1931**; India became a member in **1949** through the **London Declaration**.
- The Commonwealth currently has **56 members**; the latest member is the **Maldives**.
- Relevant Constitutional Articles: **Article 79** – Parliament; **Article 80** – Rajya Sabha; **Article 81** – Lok Sabha; **Article 52** – President of India. Head of Rajya Sabha – **Chairman**; head of Lok Sabha – **Speaker**.

11. Festivals, Heritage & History

- **International Kite Festival (Uttarayan)** – celebrated in **Gujarat**.
- **Battle of Plassey (1757)** – fought between the Nawab of Bengal and **Robert Clive**; marked the foundation of British rule in India.
- **M.S. Subbulakshmi** – associated with **Carnatic music**; discussed as a landmark woman Bharat Ratna recipient (awarded in 1998).
- **Thousand Pillar Temple** – located in **Telangana**, built by the **Kakatiya Dynasty**.

12. Ladakh's First Heritage Village – Kumik

- **Kumik village** (in the **Zaskar** region) has been declared Ladakh's **first Heritage Village**, mainly to address severe **water scarcity** and conserve local culture.
- Announced during the **Zaskar Festival** by Ladakh's Lieutenant Governor.
- The village is linked to **Tibetan Buddhism**; Buddhist manuscripts of the region are called '**Kanjur**'.
- Announced under the government programme '**Vikas Bhi, Virasat Bhi**' (Development as well as Heritage).
- Ladakh became a **Union Territory on 31 October 2019**; there is an ongoing demand to bring Ladakh under the **Sixth Schedule** of the Constitution.

13. Defence: Vayu Shakti Drone Trials

- The **Indian Air Force** is conducting **Vayu Shakti Drone Trials 2026** at **Pokhran, Rajasthan**, testing various indigenous drones.
- The '**Vayu Utthaan System**' was tested for regulating and managing **drone air-traffic**.

14. CRPF & the COBRA Battalion

- **CRPF (Central Reserve Police Force)** – formed in **1939** (earlier known as the Crown Representative's Police); governed by the **CRPF Act, 1949**; functions under the **Ministry of Home Affairs**.
- **COBRA Battalion** is a specialised CRPF unit for operations in dense forest/jungle terrain.
- For the first time, a **woman officer, IPS Sanjukta Parasar** (from the **Assam–Meghalaya cadre**), is set to lead a COBRA (women's) battalion; she is known as the '**Iron Lady of Assam**'.
- COBRA battalions currently operate mainly in **Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand**, and also in **Manipur**.

15. PM Vishwakarma Yojana – 3 Years Completed

- Launched on **17 September 2023**; completed **3 years** on 17 September 2026.
- Provides **skill training** and **collateral-free loans** to traditional artisans and craftspeople.
- So far, about **30 lakh artisans** have registered under the scheme.
- The loan amount (earlier capped near **Rs. 1 lakh**) has now been enhanced; interest rate is **5% per annum**.
- The scheme has now been formally extended to **West Bengal** as well, launched in **Kolkata** on 17 September 2026, in the presence of the **MSME Minister (Jitan Ram Manjhi)** and state leadership.
- The scheme is slated to continue till **2027-28**.

16. Dadasaheb Phalke Award

- **Dadasaheb Phalke** made India's **first feature film, Raja Harishchandra**, in **1913**; the Dadasaheb Phalke Award is given annually with the **National Film Awards**.
- The **72nd National Film Awards** will be presented on **22 September** in **Gujarat**; Best Film award has gone to '**Article 370**'.
- The **Dadasaheb Phalke Award for 2024** has been announced for veteran Kannada actor **Ananth Nag**.
- Previous recipients (recent years): **Mohanlal** and, before him, **Mithun Chakraborty**.

Quick Revision – One-Liners

- Pakistani ship involved in Arabian Sea collision: **Hunain / Alamgir**.
- Minimum distance rule between naval ships (1991): **3 nautical miles**.
- International water begins beyond: **200 nautical miles** (UNCLOS, 1982).
- India's FTAs signed so far: **38 countries**; latest: **New Zealand**.
- New Zealand PM: **Christopher Luxon**; Capital: **Wellington**.
- 'Er.' prefix for engineers allowed only in: **Karnataka** (Article 18 – Abolition of Titles).
- Engineers' Day (15 Sept) honours: **M. Visvesvaraya** (Bharat Ratna, 1955).

- GAIL CMD: **Deepak Gupta**.
- New Economic Policy year: **1991**; USSR broke into **15** countries.
- Kishau Project river: **Tons** (tributary of Yamuna); funding: **90% Central Govt.**
- FireSat satellite (forest fire detection) developed by: **Google**.
- Kabaddi is the national sport of: **Bangladesh**.
- Longest international cricket career: **Brendan Taylor** (22 yrs 148 days) > Sachin Tendulkar (22 yrs 91 days).
- 2027 Cricket World Cup hosts: **Zimbabwe, South Africa, Namibia**.
- 69th Commonwealth Parliamentary Conference venue: **Cape Town, South Africa**.
- India joined Commonwealth in: **1949** (London Declaration); total members: **56**; latest: **Maldives**.
- Ladakh's first Heritage Village: **Kumik** (Zaskar); programme: '**Vikas Bhi, Virasat Bhi**'.
- COBRA battalion's first woman commander: **IPS Sanjukta Parasar** ('Iron Lady of Assam').
- PM Vishwakarma Yojana launched: **17 Sept 2023**; artisans registered: **30 lakh**; interest: **5% p.a.**
- Dadasaheb Phalke Award 2024: **Ananth Nag**; 72nd National Film Awards: **22 Sept, Gujarat**.

MCQ / Q&A Bank – Current Affairs

Q1. Which Pakistani naval ship recently collided with an Indian warship in the Arabian Sea?

Ans: Hunain (reported in some newspapers as Alamgir).

Q2. Under UNCLOS (1982), international waters begin beyond how many nautical miles from the coast?

Ans: 200 nautical miles.

Q3. As per the 1991 rule, what is the minimum distance to be maintained between naval ships of different countries in international waters?

Ans: 3 nautical miles.

Q4. Which ministry lodged India's formal protest over the naval collision?

Ans: Ministry of External Affairs.

Q5. What is the name of India's latest nuclear-capable submarine mentioned in class?

Ans: INS Aridaman.

Q6. Which country's Parliament recently approved the Free Trade Agreement (FTA) with India?

Ans: New Zealand.

Q7. Who is the current Prime Minister of New Zealand?

Ans: Christopher Luxon.

Q8. With how many countries has India now signed FTAs in total?

Ans: 38 countries.

Q9. What strait separates New Zealand's North and South Islands?

Ans: Cook Strait.

Q10. Which Constitutional Article deals with 'Abolition of Titles'?

Ans: Article 18.

Q11. Which state has allowed engineers to use 'Er.' before their names?

Ans: Karnataka.

Q12. Engineers' Day (15 September) commemorates the birth anniversary of which engineer?

Ans: Sir M. Visvesvaraya.

Q13. In which year was Sir M. Visvesvaraya awarded the Bharat Ratna?

Ans: 1955.

Q14. In which year was the Bharat Ratna award instituted?

Ans: 1954.

Q15. Who is the current CMD of GAIL (Gas Authority of India Limited)?

Ans: Deepak Gupta.

Q16. In which year was India's New Economic Policy (liberalisation) introduced?

Ans: 1991.

Q17. Into how many countries did the USSR disintegrate in 1991?

Ans: 15 countries.

Q18. Which organisation releases the World Happiness Report?

Ans: UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network.

Q19. On which river is the Kishau Multipurpose Project being built?

Ans: Tons River (a tributary of the Yamuna).

Q20. What percentage of the Kishau Project's funding comes from the Central Government?

Ans: 90%.

Q21. Which river is the largest tributary of the Ganga?

Ans: Yamuna.

Q22. Which river is the largest tributary of the Yamuna?

Ans: Tons.

Q23. Google's FireSat satellite is used for detecting what?

Ans: Forest fires.

Q24. The International Space Station orbits in which zone, above what altitude?

Ans: Low Earth Orbit, above approx. 400 km.

Q25. The term 'Knee Hold' is used in which sport?

Ans: Kabaddi.

Q26. Kabaddi is the national sport of which country?

Ans: Bangladesh.

Q27. Which Zimbabwean cricketer has broken Sachin Tendulkar's record for the longest international career?

Ans: Brendan Taylor.

Q28. What was the length of Brendan Taylor's international career (as discussed)?

Ans: 22 years 148 days.

Q29. What was the length of Sachin Tendulkar's international career?

Ans: 22 years 91 days.

Q30. In which year did Sachin Tendulkar announce his retirement from cricket?

Ans: 2013 (after India's 2011 World Cup win).

Q31. Which three countries will co-host the 2027 Cricket World Cup?

Ans: Zimbabwe, South Africa and Namibia.

Q32. Where was the recent Under-19 Cricket World Cup held?

Ans: Harare, Zimbabwe.

Q33. Which state won the Junior Boys' National Football Championship (B.C. Roy Trophy)?

Ans: West Bengal (defeated Manipur 3-1).

Q34. Where was the 69th Commonwealth Parliamentary Conference held?

Ans: Cape Town, South Africa.

Q35. In which year did India become a member of the Commonwealth?

Ans: 1949, via the London Declaration.

Q36. How many total members does the Commonwealth of Nations have, and who is the latest member?

Ans: 56 members; latest member is the Maldives.

Q37. Which Constitutional Article establishes the Parliament of India?

Ans: Article 79.

Q38. Which Articles establish the Rajya Sabha, Lok Sabha and the President respectively?

Ans: Rajya Sabha – Article 80; Lok Sabha – Article 81; President – Article 52.

Q39. Which village has been declared Ladakh's first Heritage Village?

Ans: Kumik village, in the Zaskar region.

Q40. Under which government programme was Kumik village announced as a Heritage Village?

Ans: 'Vikas Bhi, Virasat Bhi' (Development as well as Heritage).

Q41. What are Buddhist manuscripts of the Ladakh/Zaskar region called?

Ans: Kanjur.

Q42. On what date did Ladakh become a Union Territory?

Ans: 31 October 2019.

Q43. Where is the Indian Air Force conducting the Vayu Shakti drone trials 2026?

Ans: Pokhran, Rajasthan.

Q44. What system was tested for managing drone air-traffic during the trials?

Ans: Vayu Utthaan System.

Q45. In which year was the CRPF established, and under which Act does it function?

Ans: Established in 1939; functions under the CRPF Act, 1949.

Q46. Which CRPF unit is specialised for jungle/forest operations?

Ans: COBRA Battalion.

Q47. Who is the first woman officer set to lead a COBRA (women's) battalion?

Ans: IPS Sanjukta Parasar, known as the 'Iron Lady of Assam'.

Q48. When was the PM Vishwakarma Yojana launched, and how many years has it now completed?

Ans: Launched 17 September 2023; has completed 3 years.

Q49. How many artisans have registered under the PM Vishwakarma Yojana so far?

Ans: About 30 lakh.

Q50. What is the annual interest rate on loans under the PM Vishwakarma Yojana?

Ans: 5% per annum.

Q51. Which state has newly been brought under the PM Vishwakarma Yojana, and where was it launched?

Ans: West Bengal; launched in Kolkata.

Q52. Who made India's first feature film, and what was it called?

Ans: Dadasaheb Phalke; 'Raja Harishchandra' (1913).

Q53. Who has been announced as the Dadasaheb Phalke Award 2024 recipient?

Ans: Ananth Nag.

Q54. When and where will the 72nd National Film Awards be presented?

Ans: 22 September, in Gujarat.

Q55. Which film won the Best Film award at the 72nd National Film Awards?

Ans: 'Article 370'.